

Generated from the competition table

# 1978 FIFA World Cup

Everything the FIFA World Cup edition table records about 1978, with each placing linked to that team's full history.

Host(s)

**Argentina**

Teams

**16**

Winner

**Argentina**

Runner-up

**Netherlands**

Third

**Brazil**

Fourth / other semifinalist

**Italy**

Final

**Argentina 3-1  
Netherlands (a.e.t.)**

Final date

**25 June 1978**

Top scorer

**Mario Kempes  
(Argentina, 6 goals)**

**All FIFA World Cup editions →**



## References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 14 August 2026

- **FIFA tournament history and champions** (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>).

- FIFA tournament history and champions (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain>).
- FIFA 2026 awards (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/award-winners>).
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- **\*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\*** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights>).
- **\*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\*** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" ([https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/\\_/gameId/760517/argentina-spain](https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760517/argentina-spain)).
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- **\*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\*** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final>).
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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.